

 *Amphicoelias fragillimus*
 *Argentinosaurus huinculensis*

 *Sauroposeidon proteles*
 *Supersaurus vivianae*
 *Diplodocus hallorum*

Largest land animal?

The largest animal ever to walk on Earth might have been a dinosaur called *Amphicoelias* (am-fee-SEE-lee-ass). More than a century ago, a single backbone of *Amphicoelias* was found. It was drawn and described, but then mysteriously disappeared. The description suggests *Amphicoelias* was an incredible 130–196 ft (40–60 meters) in length and 135 tons (120 metric tons) in weight.



FACT FILE

The sizes shown in the picture to the left are the maximum these animals are known to have reached. The artwork is not perfectly to scale, but it gives an idea of what these animals may have looked like if they could have been brought together.



■ **Biggest killer on land** The dinosaur *Spinosaurus* is the largest known land-dwelling meat eater. It was 50 ft (16 m) long and weighed 13½ tons (12 metric tons).



Albatross

■ **Largest flying animal** *Hatzegopteryx* was a pterosaur—a kind of flying reptile. Its wingspan was about 36 ft (11 m), making it as big as a small aeroplane. For comparison, the bird with the largest wingspan today is the wandering albatross, with a span of 12 ft (3.6 m).

■ **Largest** The blue whale is the world's largest living animal. Its heart alone is the size of a small car.



■ **Smallest dinosaur** Pigeon-sized *Anchiornis* is the smallest known prehistoric dinosaur. The Cuban bee hummingbird is the smallest living dinosaur.

African elephant
 ■ Shoulder height
 13 ft (4 m)



Triceratops
 ■ Length 30 ft (9 m)



Human

■ **Tallest man ever** 8 ft 11 in (12.7 m)

